Project Management Process Model

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1.0 Establish the Project Context

The Project Manager and selected members of the organization's Executive Team validate and document the strategic purpose and tactical governance procedures of the project and organize the Planning Team. This establishes an environment for the project that ensures strategic alignment with the organization.

1.1 Review Project Information

The Project Manager reviews the existing project documentation, confirming the information as it exists and clarifying issues and questions. This establishes a foundation of understanding upon which the Project Manager can work with the Sponsor to establish and manage an appropriately selected Planning Team.

1.1.1 Review the Project Documentation

The Project Manager reviews the project documentation. This helps the Project Manager to understand the project scope, schedule, and resource expectations, and the organizational context of the effort.

1.1.2 Confirm Project Context

The Project Manager reviews and validates project documents with Stakeholders and the Project Sponsor, identifying project constraints and interdependencies. This provides the understanding needed to organize and define the project planning effort.

1.2 Establish the Planning Structure

The Project Manager works directly with the Sponsor to identify and recruit the Planning Team for the project, and establishes the procedures that will be followed to facilitate the efficient and effective planning, execution, and closeout of the project. This establishes an environment in which the team members tasked with the development of the Project Plan are focused and successful.

1.2.1 Create the Planning Team

The Project Manager coordinates the recruiting and confirmation of the Planning Team and resource assignments, time requirements, and administrative expectations with appropriate functional managers. This opens communication and engenders support from the functional support group of each team member and resource.

1.2.2 Establish the Project Governance Framework

The Project Manager establishes and validates the procedures that will be followed to govern the project. This facilitates appropriate and effective team participation.

Create the Objective Statement

Consider these main characteristics of the project Objective Statement

- Clear
  - Remove ambiguity
  - Avoid technical terms and any jargon
  - Easy to understand by any person associated with the project
- Concise

    - Twenty-five words or less
- Complete
    - Include the Sponsor's scope, schedule, and resource expectations for the project

Create the Constraint Matrix

The Constraint Matrix indicates the relative process flexibility of the scope, schedule, and resources with a "Most Constrained," "Moderately Constrained," and "Least Constrained" assessment.
The Constraint Matrix helps the team decide early in the project how constraint decisions regarding scope, schedule, and resources are made throughout the project.

	Most Constrained	Moderately Constrained	Least Constrained
Scope		✓	
Schedule	✓		
Resources			✓

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Consider these possible constraints:

Scope

- Most Constrained
    - Well defined scope requirements
    - Very inflexible list of requirements from the user group or customers
    - Scope is mandated by a third-party organization, such as the government or a regulatory body
- Moderately Constrained
    - Some "want-to-have" items have been articulated in the scope requirements documents
    - There is indication that the roll out of the deliverable of the project could be accomplished in phases based on feature sets
- Least Constrained
    - Requirements are not very well defined and can be adjusted by the project team
    - There are minimum requirements defined that are considerably less than the overall scope development requested

Schedule

- Most Constrained
    - The deadline for completion is inflexible due to a stated and immovable deadline
    - The window for release is tight and dictated by outside influences

    - Another project is dependent on the outcome of this project
- Moderately Constrained
    - The window for release exists, however there is a range of time for deployment
    - There are more than one possible dates for completion, but the dates are defined and immovable
- Least Constrained
    - There is no driving date for completion
    - The range of time for completion is quite wide in comparison to the duration of the project

Resources

- Most Constrained
    - Specific, nontransferable skills are required to complete the work of the project
    - The budget is very tight with very little opportunity for budget enhancement
    - The FTE's in any particular functional area participating in the project are very limited
- Moderately Constrained
    - Specific skills are required to complete the work of the project, however they exist in more than one functional area of the organization
    - Budget enhancement requests are discouraged, but will be entertained
- Least Constrained
    - Skills are general to the organization
    - There is a high level of familiarity of the project work requirements in the organization
    - The project is under budget (if the organization is not in a cost constraint environment)

2.0 Plan the Project

The Project Planning Team creates and validates an appropriate Project Plan, including the Definition Document, a Resourced Schedule, a Risk Management Plan, and a Project Team structure that meets the validated strategic objectives of the project. This defines the scope, schedule, and resource expectations and guides and focuses the Project Team during the execution of the project.

2.1 Define the Project Scope

The Planning Team creates a detailed explanation of the scope of work and the corresponding tasks for accomplishing the scope as defined, adjusting the approach to governing the project based on the detailed understanding of what is to be accomplished. This lays a foundation for developing a timeline and budget that informs the organization and guides the Project Team.

2.1.1 Create the Definition Document (p451)

The Planning Team defines and documents the project scope in a Definition Document. This Definition Document captures the project requirements making them available to the stakeholders.

2.1.2 Determine the Planning and Management Approach

The Project Manager leads the Planning Team in determining the approach to planning the project, and updates the Governance Framework for the project, including associated project metrics. This facilitates the appropriate planning with effective team participation.

2.1.3 Validate Scope and Approach

The Planning Team confirms and updates the preliminary Definition Document with the Sponsor and obtains support to continue planning. This ensures that project scope and interdependencies between projects are understood and communicated.

2.1.4 Create the Work Breakdown Structure (Scope)

The Planning Team identifies the tasks required to achieve the project objectives and recommends task ownership. This identifies the activities required to accomplish the scope of the project and sets the team up for appropriate scheduling of tasks and identification of costs.

2.2 Create the Preliminary Resourced Schedule

Based on the work identified while defining the project scope, the Project Team identifies the order of work, the time requirements for accomplishing the work, the skills/people/resources required, and the relationship of the various tasks inside and outside of this project. This creates a detailed schedule of work that Project Team members reference and status against which guides the project schedule and budget.

2.2.1 Create the Preliminary Project Schedule

The Planning Team creates the Preliminary Schedule including the critical path and late schedule. This prepares the Planning Team to identify and reconcile resource requirements.

2.2.2 Identify Associated Resources

The Planning Team enters resource requirements and availability on the preliminary schedule, adjusts the schedule for resource/calendar constraints, and validates duration estimates. This provides initial time and cost estimates for the project.

2.2.3 Integrate Schedules 2-113

The Project Manager integrates the Preliminary Resourced Schedule with any other related projects. This integration ensures that the schedule reflects actual interdependencies of projects throughout the enterprise.

2.3 Complete the Plan

The Project Manager, the Planning Team, and the Sponsor work together to establish a Project Plan that supports the original documented strategic project objectives or validate modifications to the strategic objectives, supported by a plan to manage the risks to successfully meeting the validated strategic objectives. This finalizes the formal planning phase and prepares the Planning Team to segue to a Project Team focused on execution, tracking, and managing.

2.3.1 Reconcile the Existing Plan and Project Objectives

The Planning Team works to meet the original project objectives or suggests appropriate changes to the project scope, schedule, or resources. This reconciliation provides a realistic project plan ready for Sponsor review and approval.

2.3.2 Confirmation and Support of Proposed Changes

The Planning Team obtains confirmation and support from the Sponsor for the recommended changes to scope, schedule, or resources. This enables the Planning Team to focus on Risk Management Planning.

2.3.3 Create the Risk Management Plan

The Planning Team creates the Risk Management plan and updates the project plan. Planning for risks minimizes negative impact on the project and increases awareness of potential hazards.

2.3.4 Obtain Confirmation and Support of the Plan

The Planning Team confirms the optimized Project Plan and Risk Management Plan with the Sponsor and obtains support to transition the project to the execution phase. This ensures that project scope, schedule, and resources, as defined in the Project Plan, meet the strategic intent of the organization.

2.3.5 Finalize the Plan

The Planning Team prepares the final Project Plan, Project Management Team membership, and Governance Framework for approval to proceed by the Sponsor. This ensures that the Planning Team agrees with the plan for execution of the project and provides the opportunity for validation by the Sponsor.

2.3.6 Obtain Confirmation and Support to Proceed

The Project Manager confirms the finalized Project Plan Project Team membership with the Sponsor and obtains support to transition the project to the execution phase. This ensures the support of the organization as the project transitions from the planning phase to the execution phase.

3.0 Execute the Project

The Project Team facilitates the execution of the baselined Project Plan, including the formal steps of closing the project, reporting on progress and making changes to the Project Plan as needed and as validated by the Sponsor. The deliverables, the schedule, and the costs of the Project remain predictable, reliable, and consistent with the strategic intent of the organization.

3.1 Manage the Project

The Planning Team tracks the progress of the project against the baselined Project Plan, making changes to the parameters of the project as validated by key Stakeholders and communicating the status of the project to the organization until the work is completed as agreed upon. This keeps the Project Team focused on the work as approved and ensures reliable performance by the members of the Project Team.

3.1.1 Baseline the Project

Upon receipt of confirmation and support of the Project Plan, the Project Manager formally sets and communicates the project baseline and governance. This establishes the expected scope, schedule, and resource utilization as the basis for fact based project execution management and change management.

3.1.2 Monitor, Investigate, Take Action, and Report (MITAR) on Project Performance

The Project Manager, in collaboration with Core and Extended Team Members, monitors, investigates, takes action, and reports actions taken. This management process facilitates changes, issues, and risks identification and management.

3.1.3 Manage the Project Scope

The Project Manager, in collaboration with the Project Team, oversees the development of the work as defined in the baselined Project Plan. This collaborative management provides for appropriate quality management and scope change management.

3.1.4 Manage the Project Team

The Project Manager carefully monitors team participation to maintain a success-oriented environment. With attention to the work environment comes team satisfaction, higher productivity, and the ability to resolve issues in a fact-based manner.

3.1.5 Manage the Resourced Schedule

The Project Manager tracks the progress of work and resource utilization per the baselined Project Plan and reports project status. This keeps the Project Team's focus on getting the work done using the resources allocated by the organization.

3.1.6 Manage Communications

The Project Manager coordinates the communication of project information to internal and external audiences per the Governance Framework established by the Project Team. This enables appropriate visibility of the project's progress.

3.1.7 Validate Deliverable Completion

The Project Manager confirms the completion of the expected work or the cancellation of the project with the appropriate Stakeholders. This ensures that Stakeholders agree with and support the closing of the project.

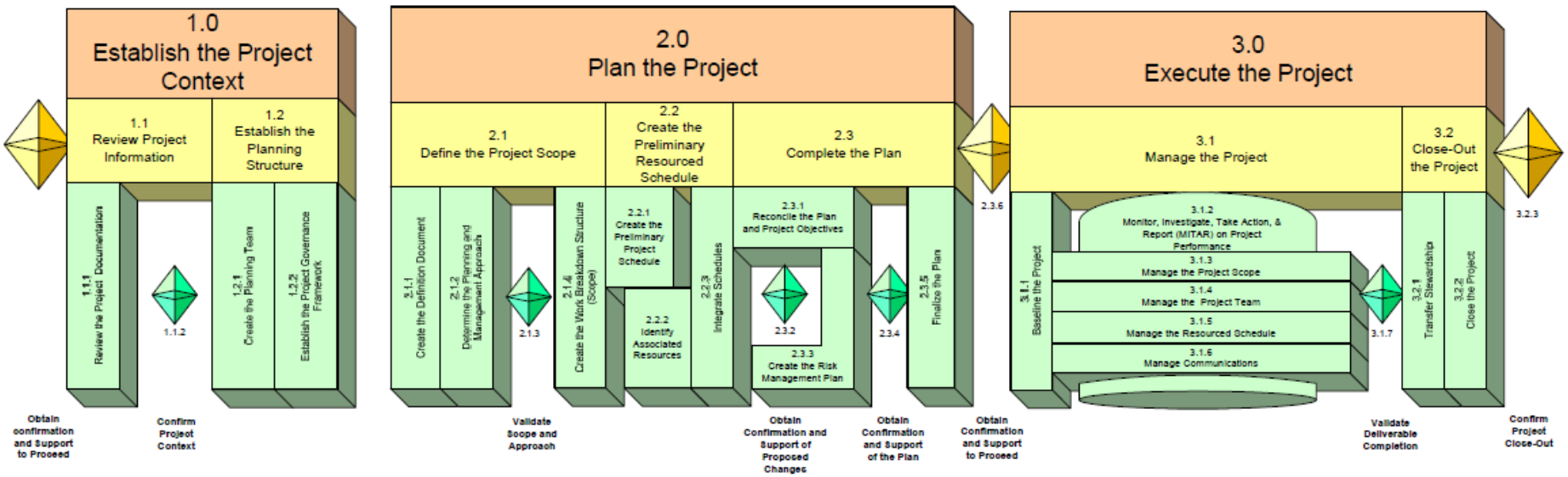
3.2 Close-out the Project

Having validated the completion of work as defined in the Project Plan and formally changed during the execution phase, the Project Manager facilitates the transfer of the deliverables to the appropriate operations group and completes the necessary paperwork to close the project. This ensures that project work does not linger beyond what is expected and that all loose ends are tied up.

3.2.1 Transfer Stewardship

The Project Manager oversees the transfer of operational responsibility of the project output to the appropriate entity(ies). Careful transitioning from project work to ongoing operations and maintenance ensures that the output is supported beyond the life of the project.

3.2.2 Close the Project

The Project Manager conducts a formal closeout session with appropriate project team members, capturing successes, challenges, and lessons learned, and completes the necessary paperwork to close out the effort. This final step formally closes the effort in the organization and ensures that administrative items are completed.

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